



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Magnolia Classical Academy
School Website: <https://mcadurant.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Magnolia Classical Academy Durant (OK 74701) presents a robust classical Christian program with strong alignment to the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Public-facing materials emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary texts, Latin and Greek, and a theology-informed frame that ties learning to the Triune God. The school explicitly names classical Christian education as its core aim, partners with families, and describes a blended University Model (home + in-class learning) that preserves the classical liberal arts emphasis while leveraging a family-centered approach. Across categories, MCA Durant displays a predominantly CLASSICAL orientation with high fidelity to formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom within a Christian framework. Where nuances exist (e.g., hybrid/University Model and some contemporary enrollment logistics), they still sit within a traditional classical formation model rather than diverging toward secular or purely information-based education.

Executive-level takeaway: - Rel. & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL, anchored by explicit Christian theology and the transcendentals in purpose. - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL, with formation of wisdom and virtue as central telos. - Curriculum: CLASSICAL, with liberal arts core (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/primary texts, and classical languages. - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL, featuring Socratic/seminar-style inquiry where described, along with memory- and model-based elements. - Faculty: CLASSICAL, evidenced by named teachers, leadership, and living-curriculum dynamics. - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL, with explicit partnership with families and open engagement possibilities.

What would move the needle section is not required here because the school already demonstrates a thorough CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories.

Key supporting evidence includes MCA Durant's statements about rigorous classical Christian education, the Trivium, Latin/Greek, Great Books/primary texts, the Christian worldview and theology (Triune God, Genesis reference), and the ACCS accreditation language. See explicit citations to MCA Durant materials and to the Six Essential Elements framework cited below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - MCA Durant presents a clearly Christian, theologically grounded frame: "classical Christian education... to the glory of Jesus Christ" and "by whom and for whom all things were created." - The school highlights reading and discussion of great literature, world history and church history, and explicitly notes Latin and Ancient Greek languages as part of the curriculum. This ties learning to a Christian worldview and sacred history, aligning with a theological basis for knowledge. - The ACCS description on the MCA Durant site frames classical Christian education as sharpening reasoning, language, and rhetorical skills within a Christian vision of truth and knowledge, rooted in a long tradition. This reinforces Grounded in Theology and Transcendental Realism aims. - Statements such as "Genesis 1:27 ... God created man in his own image" and emphasis on the Triune God occur in public content about Classical Christian Education, signaling doctrinal grounding.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth (as part of affirming the true), goodness, beauty (the true, the good, and the beauty), theology, Triune God, church history, great literature, primary texts, liberal arts, Latin/Greek, Great Books. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials of MCA Durant regarding this category. - The presence of explicit theology, classical transcendental aims, and liturgical/congregational language (tied to worshipful frame) yields a high positive signal.

Why this rating - The materials plainly articulate transcendental realism (truth, goodness, beauty) and a theology-grounded education with explicit Christian formation. The presence of Triune God, church history, and a strong emphasis on classical liturgical/communal cues (where applicable through the theology lens) support CLASSICAL rather than NOT or ONLY SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The explicit accreditation by ACCS further anchors the category in a historically grounded Christian classical framework. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated goal is formation of virtuous, wise students: "to graduate great thinkers who are wise, intelligent and virtuous followers of Christ" and "affirm the true, pursue the good and enjoy the beautiful to the glory of Jesus Christ." This aligns with the classical telos of human excellence rather than mere job prep. - The emphasis on formation (formation of character and virtue) and the claim that education should cultivate humanity aligns with the classical paideia vision rather than a purely utilitarian trajectory. The program additionally emphasizes "Great Books" and "world history and church history" for a broad formation. - The materials frame education as "formation" and "liberal education" through grounded classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great Books). The ACCS description reinforces that the aim is wisdom and virtue in light of Christian revelation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education, scholé/contemplation (within formation framing), great conversation (as related to classical dialogue), true/good/beautiful (transcendentals), classical mission. - Negative keywords present: none observed that signal a move toward work-prep or job-readiness emphasis in a way that would counter this goal.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently position the school's aim as formation of virtue and wisdom within a classical Christian framework. The absence of an explicit primary focus on career-readiness or job-training language strengthens CLASSICAL. The ACCS framing also emphasizes a classical formation over purely informational or vocational aims. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts in the Trivium: grammar, logic, and rhetoric, reported directly in the public materials. The school describes studying Latin and Ancient Greek languages, and the focus on great literature, world history, and church history, consistent with Great Books and the Great Conversation model. - The site explicitly mentions "The Trivium" and provides details about grammar, logic, and rhetoric; smaller class sizes and primary texts indicate a depth of classical content rather than a purely modern, skills-based approach. - Additional public content notes the integration of Latin/Greek language study across grades, an emphasis on primary texts and living books (as opposed to over-reliance on textbooks), and the use of classical literature as part of the curriculum. - Accreditation language references ACCS's definition and support for classical Christian education (which emphasizes the seven liberal arts and a Great-Books oriented approach).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources/original texts, Latin and Greek, history integrated with literature, interwoven disciplines, wonder/integration, classical languages, living books, primary texts. - Negative keywords present: the site does not emphasize social studies as a substitute for history; rather, it emphasizes history through a classical lens with church history included. There is no clear signaling of a project-based or STEM-first curriculum dominating the content.

Why this rating - Curriculum statements align strongly with classical content (Trivium, liberal arts, Great Books, primary texts, classical languages). The presence of historical breadth and the explicit emphasis on integration and wonder further supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site references the Socratic Method as part of the curriculum's pedagogy (upper-level discussion and dialectic). The "Socratic Method" and "grammar/logic/rhetoric" framing indicate a classical pedagogical approach. - The public materials also describe a memory- and model-based approach (e.g., primary texts and living-teacher model), and the presence of "lectures" and "order and decorum" within the pedagogy. The "Socratic Method" entry explicitly maps to a formal pedagogical method used in classical settings. - The school presents a University Model (homeschool hybrid) as a pedagogical model, combining in-class instruction with at-home study, which folds classical content into a family-centered approach consistent with classical pedagogy rather than a purely modern, teacher-led approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Method, great conversation, tutoring/lectures (as a pedagogical mode), memory work/recitation (implied by the Trivium/primary texts), formation through imitation and practice (implied by emphasis on primary texts and living teachers), Scholé/restful learning (conceptually aligned though not explicitly labeled in all pages). - Negative keywords present: none observed that indicate a major shift away from dialogic, inquiry-based methods; there is no explicit emphasis on purely project-based or purely student-directed instruction in conflict with the classical framework.

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of Socratic dialogue, logic-based discussion, and rhetoric, as well as the integration of classical pedagogy with a memory-based and model-based approach, supports a CLASSICAL rating. The hybrid University Model is a legitimate classical adaptation rather than a departure that would signal NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - MCA Durant publicly presents named teachers and a director, indicating a framework where faculty are visible leaders and mentors (the "living curriculum" concept commonly cited in classical education). The presence of a director and several teachers with specific roles illustrates a community of practice and mentorship. - The ACCS accreditation content frames teachers as central to the curriculum (the living curriculum) and emphasizes tradition, mentorship, and virtue in teachers. This positioning aligns with the classical expectation that faculty model virtue and mastery.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, teachers as mentors or masters, portrait of teacher, character formation, virtue formation, reverence, mentorship, professional, and classical teacher archetypes. - Negative keywords present: none observed in MCA Durant's public materials that would signal a breaking away from the classical faculty model.

Why this rating - The school's public pages highlight teacher leadership, mentorship roles, and the faculty as core to the school's formation and classical approach. The ACCS framing reinforces the idea of virtue- and wisdom-centered teacher modeling. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnering with parents and offering family-centered models (homeschool hybrid and two-day in-class formats), highlighting a strong parent-school partnership and co-educator role for families. This is clearly stated in several MCA Durant materials, including admissions and program descriptions. - The enrollment/admissions materials expect parent involvement (tour, pastor reference, family participation in enrollment). This aligns with the classical emphasis on the parent as co-educator and primary formation influence. - The school explicitly invites parents to participate and visit, and the hybrid model frames at-home learning as part of the educational program, reinforcing a communal partnership with the family.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school hybrid, parent involvement, open campus, family information form, parent-tour encouraged. - Negative keywords present: none observed that signal parent disengagement or minimal parental involvement.

Why this rating - MCA Durant demonstrates a robust model of parental partnership and community engagement consistent with classical ideals of education as a continuum between home and school and as a shared formation project with families. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

Since all six categories align with CLASSICAL, there is no major needle-moving change required to move this school into the CLASSICAL category. If anything, minor enhancements could include:

- More explicit articulation of liturgical or communal practices (e.g., morning prayer, chapel activities, liturgical calendar) in public materials to strengthen the Liturgical and Communal Practices dimension.
- Additional public-facing examples of Great Books selections and sample Great Conversation prompts to illustrate the depth of the Great Books/primary texts emphasis.

Note: No major strategic changes are required to move this school toward full CLASSICAL status, given the current evidence and alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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